Reflection on Group Assignment 2IRR00

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1 Project Description and Scope

The idea of the project was to make an audio book player that is accessible for elderly people. It must be able to show the user an overview of all available audio books and chapters per book and play these.
Some of the main features include the program being able to read audio books from a specified folder, playing these audio files, adjusting the speed and volume, and saving the listening progress of these audio books.
We have been able to implement all our requirements.

2 Project Reflection

Overall the project went well and we have managed to complete it. This project has taught me how to work with GitHub and JavaFX, which will most likely be very useful in the future. Moreover, I have learned some useful project management skills. I believe this will help me with future group projects.
The main problems we've had so far we've had so far were people being unavailable for at least a week due to different circumstances, however, these people made up for it by putting in extra work later. Other times, people were very busy with other courses or suffering from a mental health decline. Luckily, other team members were able to take over for them at the time.
The other problem is that we have had to focus on the concept and presentation of our idea, which caused us to neglect coding work, meaning we had to work hard during the last few weeks, as we were a bit behind schedule. However, in the end, it all got finished. In the future, we will make a planning in advance and give each part enough time. This way, we can also make sure people won't fall behind on their tasks too much or detect this early in the process, meaning others will be able to step in in time.

2.1 Process and Collaboration

I feel the collaboration on this project has gone quite well. Some people were absent during the first or second week, but they have made this up by contribution more later on. We regularly scheduled meetings and took notes during these to document the tasks everyone had done and make action points for what needed to be done and who needed to do it.
Of course, every group project also has it downsides when it comes to collaboration. For various reasons, some people fell behind on their tasks from time to time. Whenever this happened, we managed to have someone else help them with their task, or even finish it for them. This way, we managed to fulfill all requirements in the end.

2.2 Testing and Quality Assurance

We have used black-box testing as our main testing strategy. The testing has gone well in my opinion. Everyone made sure to test their own features, and after everything worked, we merged branches and tested everything together. We can conclude now that everything works as it is supposed to.

2.3 Design Principles and Patterns

During the programming phase of this course, I have implemented many design patterns. For example, I have made many classes into a singleton. However, it turned out that many of these classes didn't need to be a singleton, making me delete many singleton instances. In the end, we have kept only a few design patterns. For example, our Settings class is a singleton.
I have learned a lot from all the design patterns explained in the lectures, though in my experience, these aren't always necessary. The most important thing is having a well organized code. Design patterns can help with this, but don't need to be implemented everywhere.

3 Self-Reflection

For this project, I have worked on presentations and helped with the use cases and the requirements for our project. Moreover, I was responsible for the home view. This included the home view GUI elements, making sure the settings and library buttons worked and implementing a list with recently opened audio books. Most of this has been implemented in the HomeViewController class, though I've had to use and implement methods in other classes too. Of course, connected to this are the homeview CSS and fxml files.

I have learned how to efficiently take notes during meetings, by taking actions points for example. During the lectures, I have learned about structures that can be implemented in code. Besides just learning about them, I have also been able to implement some, like singletons.
And since we worked with JavaFX, I have learned much about that, too, as I had never used it before. At the start, this caused some issues, but after getting help from my teammates, I was able to effectively program it as well.
Another tool I had never used before was GitHub. During the project, I got practice with using this, too. At some point, I accidentally caused a problem, but after asking what I did wrong exactly, I now know how to avoid this in the future. This is especially useful for future projects, as I will most likely need to use GitHub in the future, too.

4 Conclusion and Learnings

All in all, the collaboration on this project has gone well, even though we had a few struggles here and there.
I have learned skills that will be useful in the future regarding collaboration and programming, such as how to take notes during meetings, how to use GitHub, how to use JavaFX and how to implement certain design patterns.